Engineering Tripos Part IIA Module Experiment: 3C6

Digital Vibration Analysis, South Wing Mechanics Laboratory

1. Objectives

- To measure the calibrated transfer function of a vibrating structure using several common experimental methods;
- To predict the response of a coupled structure from the measured transfer functions of its decoupled subsystems;
- To compare the advantages and disadvantages of the different experimental methods.

2. Preparation

DO THIS FIRST: Turn on the PC and log in using your usual Teaching System ID and password. It can take a while for the windows profile to load.

If the power is not on at the benches, turn on the switches on the pillar at the north end of the bench, labelled "computers" and "bench sockets". You may need to plug in the two BNC cables carrying your input and output signals to the diecast box at the rear of the computer trolley. Your cables are labelled "3C6 CH1" and "3C6 CH2", to be plugged into the corresponding channels. In the software, channels are numbered from 0: CH1 (the force signal) is channel 0, and CH2 (the accelerometer) is channel 1.

When using the magnets make sure they are well seated. If they are not, you will hear buzzing or rattling. Remove the magnet and wipe both surfaces with your finger to remove any grit. Moving the magnet slightly is often all that is needed to get rid of the buzz. If the buzz persists, try using a lower vibration level.

3C6 Lab Assistant

As a way to help guide you through the lab experiment, there is a Claude Lab Assistant for this lab (or scan the QR code to open it on your phone). You will need to sign in with a Claude account (a free account is enough). Its intended purpose is to help get good data during the experiment - it has been given the lab handout and some extra hints, so think of it as a smart way to search this handout. It has not been given answers to the lab report questions and it should not be used to help in this way.

3C6 Lab Assistant

On your phone, open it in a web browser (Safari, Chrome), not the Claude app: the Lab Assistant does not work in the Claude app. If scanning the QR code opens the Claude app, type or paste this link into your phone's browser instead:

`https://claude.ai/artifact/RHdf53JoEoNqtkpcLGgSz1`

3. Experimental procedure

3.1 Sine wave measurements (30 minutes)

If the computer is not already on, switch it on, then log in using your usual Teaching System ID and password.

For the first part of the experiment you will measure a transfer function using the stepped-sine method:

1. Click '3C6_Notebook.ipynb' to open the notebook.
2. Attach the shaker to the bottom beam using the magnetic connector (align the rod to the shaker carefully before tightening the connection screws) and insert the brass coupling rod between the two beams if it is not already there.
3. Attach the accelerometer to the top beam directly above the coupling rod. Make sure the cables are clear of the beams.
4. Set the selector switch to “Sine”.
5. Run the code below.

Remember:

- to actually run a cell of code, click inside the cell then press 'shift+enter'
- the cell is running while [*] is displayed
- the cell has finished running when it changes to a number
- under the 'view' menu above you can toggle off the header and toolbar, which is useful to give a bit more screen space
- you can control the cell output view by clicking on the left beside the cell: single click to expand/compress, double-click to hide.

```
import matplotlib
import numpy as np
import lab_3c6
import pydvma as dvma
```

```
%matplotlib widget
```

```
# acquisition setup
settings = dvma.MySettings(channels=2,
                           fs=3000,
                           viewed_time=1,
                           device_driver = 'nidaq')
```

In this part of the lab we want to measure the gain and phase shift from input to output at the specific frequencies of the generator. To do this we will use a simple interface embedded in the notebook.

1. Start the stepped-sine logging widget by running the code in the next cell. Under the buttons, a thin bar for each channel shows its signal level, and turns red with a **CLIP** warning if a signal reaches the input limit;
2. Tap the top beam gently with a finger and check that the level bars respond;
3. Use the sine-wave generator to explore the system response in the frequency range 10–500 Hz;
4. For each frequency tested, allow a short time for the vibration to settle to a steady state (watch the level bars), then click the “Measure” button on the computer;

5. A dot will be plotted on the screen showing the admittance at the measured frequency;
6. Explore up and down in frequency until you have dotted out a reasonable picture of the admittance (you should find at least four resonance peaks). Unwanted data points can be deleted using the "Delete Last Measurement" button. Be particularly careful to catch the peak values, where the system has resonances.

You don't have to wait long between measurements: you can get quite fast at changing frequency, pausing half a second, clicking "measure", and repeat.

Aim to get about 100 data points.

When you have gathered sufficient data points, type a file name in the box under the buttons (it starts as 'stepped_sine'), then click "Save Data" and "Save Fig". "Save Data" writes *name*.dvma and "Save Fig" writes *name*.png and *name*.pdf. An existing file is never overwritten: if the name is taken, type a new one. You need to save your data as well as the figure so you can read it back again later.

Any files you save during this experiment should be saved to where this notebook has already been copied to and is the default location for all saved data. Do not put files on the local disk of the PC you are using.

```
# log data
logger1 = lab_3c6.measure_stepped_sine(settings)
```

Make sure you remembered to save both the data and the figure!

CHECK: Have you saved the data (you should have a *.dvma file)

CHECK: Have you saved the figure (you should have both a *.pdf and *.png file - the 'Save Fig' button saves both at once)

You will need the data later: to check that you have saved it, you can reload and replot it. Run the next cell and pick your stepped-sine file in the list, then run the cell after it. Note that the individual points are now plotted as a continuous line. There's no need to save the figure below as well, having saved it above.

```
# choose your stepped-sine data file in the list
picker = lab_3c6.choose_file()
```

```
data_stepped_sine = picker.load()
data_stepped_sine.plot_tf_data()
```

For the report:

1. Comment on your general observations of the data.
2. Comment on the advantages and disadvantages of this method.
3. Comment on the accuracy of this method.

3.2 Random noise excitation (30 minutes)

Switch to "Noise" on the selector, and you will hear the sound of the cantilever system responding to such a signal, generated by an analogue noise generator.

The data acquisition used for the rest of the lab will use the 'pydvma' logger interface that is more general than the embedded widget above. Open the logger by running the next cell **once** (shift+enter): it opens in a new

browser tab, and you will use it for the rest of the lab. (The widget's level bars above stop when the logger starts using the hardware.)

- **Arrange your screen:** put this notebook on the left half of the screen and the logger's browser window on the right half (drag each window to the edge of the screen, or press the Windows key + ← / →). The logger adapts to a narrow window.
- **Where files are saved:** the logger saves into the folder this notebook is in, and the folder button at the top of the logger names it. **Save Dataset** and **Save Figure** open a save dialog there: type a file name and press **Save** (**Choose location...** saves one file somewhere else).
- **Setup is already filled in** from the settings in the next cell (NI device, 2 channels, 3000 Hz, 2 s). You will only change the duration and the trigger later, when the instructions tell you to.

Familiarise yourself with the logger:

- the row of **stages** (Setup, Acquire, Live, Time, Frequency, TF, ...) takes you through a measurement; each analysis stage has a card of settings above the plot.
- the **tray** at the side lists your datasets: click a set's name to show, fade or hide it, double-click it to rename it (useful for legends), and **×** deletes it.
- click a line in the plot's **legend** to show, fade or hide it.
- the **toolbar** above the plot has **Box zoom** and **Pan**, ↶ to undo a zoom, and **Auto X** / **Auto Y** to fit the axes to the visible lines. The chevron at its right end opens exact axis limits, the legend position and the coherence axis range.
- the header has **Load Data**, **Save Figure** and **Save Dataset**.
- **Live** is the oscilloscope (time signal, spectrum, and signal levels with a **CLIP** warning), and a small monitor stays at the side on every stage: press **Start** on it and keep an eye on the levels.

```
# acquisition setup
settings = dvma.MySettings(channels=2,
                           fs=3000,
                           stored_time=2,
                           device_driver = 'nidaq')
# open the logger in a new browser tab: run this cell only once
logger = dvma.launch(settings, window='hann', tf_averaging='none')
```

We will explore the effect of some different logging options, starting with a 2 second measurement (the **duration** in Setup). In the logger:

1. Press **'Log Data'** (Acquire stage) to log data using these settings. When it finishes, the logger shows the Time stage.
2. You should have a single measurement: one set in the tray, shown as two lines in the figure.
3. If you have made more measurements then delete the extra sets (**×** on their tray cards), so that you have a single measurement. Double-click the set's name in the tray to rename it, e.g. 'noise 2s'.
4. On the **Export** stage, tick both **PNG** and **PDF** (the logger keeps this choice until its page is reloaded). Then press **'Save Figure'** (header) to save the time data plot: type a file name in the save dialog and press **Save**
5. On the **Frequency** stage press **'Calc FFT'** to calculate the FFT using the window on its card: the default 'hann' is appropriate here
6. Press **'Save Figure'** to save the plot
7. On the **TF** stage press **'Calc TF'** to calculate the Transfer Function: the settings cell has set window 'hann' and avg 'none', and in=0 (channel 0, the force signal) is appropriate here. We will use the averaging option later.
8. **Zoom in on the frequency range of interest (0-500 Hz) and adjust the y-scale appropriately using 'Auto Y' (toolbar above the plot)**

9. Press **'Save Figure'** to save the plot. It will save a *.png and *.pdf of the figure as seen on the screen:
    - You can adjust the x-y scales using Box zoom, or type exact limits in the toolbar's chevron panel
    - You can choose the legend location (toolbar's chevron panel)
    - You can show, fade or hide lines by clicking on them in the legend
10. Press **'Save Dataset'** (header) to save all the data (it will save the data that has been calculated so far, so press it after you have calculated the FFT and Transfer Functions)

Next repeat the steps above, but logging for 30 seconds instead: delete the 2 second set from the tray (you have saved it), run the next cell to set a 30 s duration, and log again.

```
# 30 second noise measurement
settings = dvma.MySettings(channels=2,
                           fs=3000,
                           stored_time=30,
                           device_driver = 'nidaq')
logger.apply_settings(settings)
```

- **CHECK 1: Did you remember to re-run the test with a 30 second duration?**
- **CHECK 2: Did you remember to save your data *after* calculating the transfer function?**
- **CHECK 3: Did you remember to save the figures that you want to keep for the report?**

Remember to save your data as well as all figures to the teaching system

Understanding the logger:

When you press 'Save Dataset', the logger saves a <DataSet> object which has the following structure:

```
<DataSet> class:
      time_data_list: [<TimeData>, <TimeData>, <TimeData>]
      freq_data_list: [<FreqData>, <FreqData>, <FreqData>]
cross_spec_data_list: []
        tf_data_list: [<TfData>, <TfData>, <TfData>]
     modal_data_list: []
      sono_data_list: []
      meta_data_list: []
```

Each type of data is arranged in 'sets', e.g. each measurement will add another <TimeData> set to time_data_list. This example has three sets of each data type. Similarly each time you load data it will add the loaded sets to the appropriate data list.

- When you press 'Calc FFT' then a <FreqData> item is calculated for each <TimeData> set.
- When you press 'Calc TF' then a <TfData> item is calculated for each <TimeData> set.
- When you press 'Calc TF' with average='across sets' then a single <TfData> item is calculated averaging across all <TimeData> items, with an assumption that the time data sets all have the same settings.

We can compare the transfer functions from the two measurements as follows:

1. Keep your 30 second noise test data (don't delete it)
2. Press **'Load Data'** (header) and open your data from the 2 second noise test: loading adds the file's sets alongside the ones already in the tray
3. On the **TF** stage, compare the transfer functions from the two measurements

Note that pressing 'Calc TF' will also work here as the settings used to calculate both transfer functions are the same. *BUT later you will want to compare transfer functions computed using different settings: then don't press*

'Calc TF' or change the TF card's settings, as either recalculates every set the same way.

Remember to save your comparison data and figures to the teaching system

If you accidentally close the logger tab, you can re-open it with the next cell (and accept the offer to restore your session):

```
import webbrowser
webbrowser.open(logger.url)
```

To smooth out the transfer functions we can average the data: recall that the transfer function is given by:

$$G(\omega) = \frac{E[YX^*]}{E[XX^*]}$$

where X and Y are the FFTs of the input and output respectively, and $E[\cdot]$ denotes the expectation (or average). If we take the whole time series then no averages are taken. But we can split the time data into sections (or 'frames'), apply a window to remove discontinuities at the edges of each frame, calculate the FFT of each frame, then take the averages of those.

1. Delete the 2 second set from the tray (**×**), keeping the 30 second one, so that the averaging settings apply only to it (or press 'Load Data' and open your 30 second noise data file)
2. On the **TF** stage set window='hann' and avg='within set'
3. Use the **N frames** slider to investigate the effect of averaging with different numbers of frames (you can also type in its box; the frame length, nFFT and Δf follow)
4. Save plots for the cases N=1, N=30 and your choice of N that gives the 'best' transfer function estimate
5. Be careful to watch the coherence near the peaks as N increases.

Note that you can use the toolbar above the plot (e.g. Box zoom), or for more careful control the exact axis limits in its chevron panel. Note that the coherence is labelled on the right-hand y-axis, and its range (0–1 or auto) is set in the same panel, separately to the transfer function y-axis scale.

If you accidentally close the logger tab, you can re-open it with the next cell (and accept the offer to restore your session):

```
import webbrowser
webbrowser.open(logger.url)
```

- **CHECK 1: Did you remember to save your data *after* calculating the transfer function *using your best choice of N frames*? You will need this later for the comparisons.**
- **CHECK 2: Did you remember to save the figures that you want to keep for the report?**

Remember to save your data as well as all figures to the teaching system.

For the report:

1. Comment on the 2s vs 30s data.
2. Why do you think the transfer function estimates are noisy without averaging?
3. What do you observe about the transfer function smoothness and the coherence as N increases?
4. Justify your choice of your 'best' value for N.

3.3 Impulsive excitation (20 minutes)

1. Remove the magnet and rod which attaches the shaker to the beams.
2. Move the accelerometer to the underneath of the beams to where the shaker was previously connected.
3. Switch the selector to “Hammer”.
4. In the logger, delete the noise set from the tray (**×**): you have already saved it. Then run the code cell just below these steps, which sets a 6 s duration and arms the trigger (on ch 0, the hammer), and press **'Log Data'** (Acquire stage);
5. Tap gently on the top of the beams vertically above the accelerometer. Tap within 20 seconds of pressing 'Log Data' to avoid a timeout (the Acquire card shows 'armed — waiting for trigger...' until you tap). The logger will automatically save the signal starting 100 samples just before the tap (specified by the 'pretrig_samples' variable).
6. **Data will be collected by the computer for 6 s: hold the hammer still and don’t put it down on the bench until it is finished.**
7. **Check your hammer impulse on the Time stage.**
   - Is it clipped (the **CLIP** warning lights, or a flat top at ±5 V)?
   - Is the signal too small (peak below about 0.5 V, 10 % of the range)?
   - Was there a single, clean impact or multiple impacts?
   - Was there any vibration before the impulse? Make sure the beams were not still vibrating from a previous impulse.
   - Did you hear any rattling or buzzing sounds? Try a lighter tap.
   - Be prepared to practice your tapping technique until you get good results. Don't proceed until you've got a single clean impulse.

```
# hammer settings: 6 s capture, trigger armed on ch 0 (the hammer), no window
settings = dvma.MySettings(channels=2,
                           fs=3000,
                           stored_time=6,
                           pretrig_samples=100,
                           device_driver = 'nidaq')
logger.apply_settings(settings, window=None, tf_averaging='none')
```

8. **Zoom in on the time signals so you can see the individual samples of the impulse and before the impulse (Box zoom on the Time stage; the card's 'First 0.2 s' button is a quick start). This will be needed for some of the questions on this section. Save this figure.**
9. Calculate frequency spectra using 'Calc FFT' on the **Frequency** stage (the settings cell has set the window to 'none'). Save this figure.

10. Calculate a transfer function using 'Calc TF' on the **TF** stage (the settings cell has set window 'none' and avg 'none') to compare with those obtained by the earlier methods. You should find that the result is satisfactory, with sharp clear peaks and troughs, without any need for averaging. If it is not, try again. You may have to develop your hammering technique a little to obtain best results. If you find it hard to get a clean transfer function then try moving the magnet, and checking that the brass coupling rod between the beams is well seated. It takes very little time to repeat the impulse response procedure. **You will find the write-up much easier with good data.** Save this figure.

- **CHECK 1: Did you remember to zoom in on the appropriate part of your data (0-500Hz and press Auto Y).**
- **CHECK 2: Did you remember to save your data *after* calculating the transfer function?**
- **CHECK 3: Did you remember to save the figures that you want to keep for the report?**

Remember to save your data (after calculating the FFT and transfer function) and figures to the teaching system

Now load the data from each of your previous measurements, and plot the transfer functions.

- **DO:** remove every set from the tray (**×** on each card) to clear existing data
- **DO:** use 'Load Data' (header) to load your chosen datasets
- **DO:** load your hammer data first: for reasons that become clear later
- **DO:** load your best 'averaged' smooth data from the noise-input section
- **DO:** load your stepped-sine data
- **DO:** use the **TF** stage for comparisons
- **DON'T:** press 'Calc TF' or change the TF card's settings, otherwise the transfer functions will all be recalculated using the same settings. You don't want this: you want to compare your transfer functions that have each been calculated using the right choices of windows and averaging.

If you accidentally close the logger tab, you can re-open it with the next cell (and accept the offer to restore your session):

```
import webbrowser
webbrowser.open(logger.url)
```

The most obvious difference should be that the hammer results are shifted vertically relative to the noise results. This is because the two input signals need different calibration factors. The computer can calculate an appropriate scale factor to allow direct comparison:

Zoom in to the frequency range 0-500 Hz, then press **'Best match'** (in the TF card's scaling group, with ref ch = ch_1). A message reports the scale factor applied to each dataset, with an Undo. All datasets are scaled to match the first set in the tray, which is why you should load the hammer data first. If you didn't, choose the hammer set in the TF card's **dataset** list before pressing 'Best match'.

Remember to save your data and figures (showing the three measured transfer functions together) to the teaching system

For the report:

1. Comment on the zoomed-in data of the impulse:
   - How long is the impulse? What does that mean for the spectra of the input and output signals?
   - Why are the accelerometer and hammer signals slightly non-zero before the impulse? There may be different reasons for each.
   - Using 'Calc FFT' look at the spectra of the input and output signals - how does this compare with what you would expect from an ideal impulse? Why does it tail off at both low and high frequencies? And why should no window function be used for this test?
2. Compare the results from the three measurement methods (stepped sine, noise, and impulse hammer), using the scaled data so they are all aligned.
3. Comment on similarities and differences:
   - Why are the natural frequencies not identical for the different methods?
   - Can you explain why there are more significant differences at low frequencies? Note that the hammer method shows peaks that are not visible in the shaker data. Can you explain why? (Hint: the shaker is applied between the base the cantilevers, while the hammer is not).
   - What else is similar / different and can you suggest reasons why?
   - Consider suggesting how you could test your suggested reasons using further experiments (no need to carry out these tests).

3.4 Calibration (20 minutes)

The final stage of the measurement is to calibrate your transfer functions to give results in physical units.

1. Move the accelerometer to the suspended mass behind the cantilevers.
2. In the logger, remove every set from the tray (**×**): you have saved them. Then run the settings cell below (the same hammer settings as 3.3, in case anything changed).
3. Use the hammer to measure a good transfer function of this mass, swinging in a straight line.
4. Log several measurements.
5. Convert the transfer function to show acceleration/force instead of velocity/force. To do this:
   - After logging the data, on the **TF** stage press 'Calc TF' (the settings cell has set window 'none' and avg 'across sets'; the result is drawn on the first set)
   - Set **x(iω)^** to +1 (the TF card's scaling group), i.e. multiplication by $i\omega$. This changes only the plot, not your data.
   - The transfer function should now show a near-horizontal line over a range of frequencies.
6. Make your best estimate of the value of this constant level: to convert the decibel value back to a linear value note that:

$$Y_{\mathrm{dB}} = 20 \log_{10} |Y_{\mathrm{linear}}|$$

7. The transfer function for a free mass is very simple: just rearrange $F = ma$, and the mass (weight plus accelerometer) is given on a label on the apparatus: approximately 0.3 kg.
8. Hence deduce the factor by which the measured transfer function must be multiplied in order to give a calibrated result.

- **The calibration factor is defined here to be the factor by which the measured data should be multiplied in order to give the actual values.**
- **The calibration factor is not the value of the horizontal line: you need to compare this value with what you expect for the transfer function of a free mass.**

```
# hammer settings: 6 s capture, trigger armed on ch 0 (the hammer), no window
settings = dvma.MySettings(channels=2,
                           fs=3000,
                           stored_time=6,
                           pretrig_samples=100,
                           device_driver = 'nidaq')
logger.apply_settings(settings, window=None, tf_averaging='across')
```

Remember to save your data and figures to the teaching system

Work out your calibration factor in the next cell (a convenient place to show your working), then check it in the logger: hover the first set's card in the tray and press **cal**. In its **Transfer function** section (not the channel rows), type your factor, pick the unit **m/s** over **N** (the transfer function as measured), and press **Apply**. The flat line should now sit at 1/m, i.e. $20\log_{10}(1/m)$ dB. Save this figure.

```
calibration_factor = ### enter or calculate your value here
print(calibration_factor)
```

Now apply your calibration factor to your measured transfer function from the impulsive excitation test and resave your calibrated data using a different filename:

1. Remove every set from the tray (**×**), then press **'Load Data'** and open your hammer data from 3.3.
2. Hover its card in the tray and press **cal**. In the **Transfer function** section, type your calibration factor, pick **m/s** over **N**, and press **Apply**.
3. Press **'Save Dataset'** and give it a new name, e.g. 'hammer_calibrated'.

Note that this needs the transfer function saved with your hammer data in 3.3. If it wasn't, press 'Calc TF' on the TF stage (window 'none', avg 'none') after loading it, then calibrate. If you closed the logger tab, re-open it with the next cell:

```
import webbrowser
webbrowser.open(logger.url)
```

Calibrated Comparison

Now load, calibrate and compare your data from all three measurements as the culmination of this part of the experiment. Use your best data from each section (i.e. don't forget to use your averaged noise input data).

1. Use 'Load Data' to load each of the datasets to be compared:
   - **KEEP YOUR CALIBRATED HAMMER SET IN THE TRAY AS THE FIRST SET** (or remove every set and load the calibrated hammer file first)
   - Then load the uncalibrated data from the stepped sine and noise input tests
   - When loading the noise input dataset choose the one with your best choice of N frames
2. Go to the **TF** stage to see the transfer function data.
3. When all three transfer functions are shown, then zoom into the frequency range 0-500 Hz and press **'Best match'** (in the TF card's scaling group, with ref ch = ch_1). This finds and applies a calibration factor to match the amplitudes of the other datasets to the amplitude of the first set in the tray: this is why the calibrated hammer data needed to be first.

- **CHECK 1: Did you remember to save your data after calibrating the data?**

- **CHECK 2: Did you remember to save the figures that you want to keep for the report?**

Remember to save your calibrated comparison data and figures to the teaching system

---

For the report:

1. Show your working and calculated value for the calibration constant
2. Show a plot of your final calibrated set of transfer functions. Don't forget to use the calibration constant on the hammer data then match the shaker data to the hammer data, not the other way around.
3. Comment on the accuracy of your calibration.

3.5 Coupling of subsystems (20 minutes)

Finally, we will measure the transfer functions of the uncoupled beams to predict the coupled response.

Using the hammer method obtain admittances for the two cantilevers separately (by removing the coupling rod, removing the magnetic shaker attachment, and moving the accelerometer appropriately — you may need to practice your upside-down hammering technique!). You will measure both beams in the logger and save them together, in one file.

1. In the logger, remove every set from the tray (**×**), then run the settings cell below (the same hammer settings again).
2. Measure the upper beam, and press 'Calc TF' on the **TF** stage to check its transfer function (the settings cell sets window 'none' and avg 'none'). Get the best result you can: delete any poor attempt (**×**) and tap again, until one good set remains. Double-click the set's name in the tray and rename it 'upper beam'.
3. Move the accelerometer to the lower beam and do the same, renaming its set 'lower beam'.
4. You should now have exactly two sets in the tray, the two beams, each with its transfer function. Press **'Save Dataset'** and give the file a name such as 'beams'.

Remember to save your data and figures to the teaching system

```
# hammer settings: 6 s capture, trigger armed on ch 0 (the hammer), no window
settings = dvma.MySettings(channels=2,
                           fs=3000,
                           stored_time=6,
                           pretrig_samples=100,
                           device_driver = 'nidaq')
logger.apply_settings(settings, window=None, tf_averaging='none')
```

Now you can use these measurements to predict the response of the coupled system. The admittance of the coupled system is related to the admittances $Y_1(\omega)$, $Y_2(\omega)$ of the two separate systems by the formula:

$$\frac{1}{Y_{\text{coupled}}} = \frac{1}{Y_1(\omega)} + \frac{1}{Y_2(\omega)}$$

which is derived in Section 7 of the lecture notes, and is similar to the formula for parallel resistors.

To calculate the coupled admittance using these measurements, run the next cell and pick your two-beam file, then run the cell after it, then the "lab_3c6.coupled_TF" cell. It reports which two transfer functions it couples: check they are your two beams.

Note that this will only work if you saved the file above after calculating the transfer functions. If you didn't, load it in the logger, press 'Calc TF' (window 'none', avg 'none') and save it again.

```
# pick your two-beam data file in the list, then run the cell below it
picker = lab_3c6.choose_file()
```

```
data_beams = picker.load()   # with your two-beam file picked
```

```
data_coupled = lab_3c6.coupled_TF(data_beams)
```

```
data_coupled.save_data('coupled_prediction')
```

Load the saved data into the logger:

1. Remove every set from the tray (**×**).
2. Use 'Load Data' to load your coupled prediction (coupled_prediction.dvma) and your uncalibrated hammer data from 3.3, and compare them on the **TF** stage.

- **CHECK 1: Did you remember to save your comparison data?**
- **CHECK 2: Did you remember to save the figures that you want to keep for the report?**

Remember to save your comparison data and figures to the teaching system

If you accidentally close the logger tab, you can re-open it with the next cell (and accept the offer to restore your session):

```
import webbrowser
webbrowser.open(logger.url)
```

For the report:

1. Compare your predicted transfer function with the directly measured transfer function. Does this method give a reliable way to deduce the behaviour of coupled systems? If not, why not?
2. Comment on similarities and differences, suggesting reasons for any differences observed.

AT THE END OF THE EXPERIMENT

- **check you have saved your data and figures to the teaching system**
- **if there is no shortcut to your network folder, you can find your files by opening File Explorer and typing `\\ifs\users\CRSID\lab_3C6` (with your own CRSID) in its address bar**
- **share your data with lab-group partners and your own devices (e.g. using WeTransfer, or by uploading them to your OneDrive account in a web browser)**
- **sign-out of the pc**

NOTE:

- **The logger runs inside this notebook: when you close the notebook (or restart its kernel), the logger stops.**
- **Therefore, please remember to save data and figures as needed for the report before leaving the lab**
- **The pydvma logger is opensource, so you can install it on your own device (windows/mac/linux). To look at your .dvma files at home with nothing installed, open them in the browser version at torebutlin.github.io/pydvma/app/. Contact tb267 if you have any problems.**

4. Write-up for laboratory report (3 hours)

The write-up of this experiment as coursework for module 3C6 should be short. Download the template from the 3C6 moodle site (bit.ly/cued3c6). As a guide, the text should be no more than three A4 sides, plus appropriate plots of experimental results. Your report should include representative results from all the stages of the experiment, including the final calibrated comparison of all measurement methods. It need only give a very brief description of the experimental procedure, but it should contain answers to the various questions asked in this sheet, and a critical discussion of the results which might take the form of short bullet points in reference to the experimental results.

When writing up, please concentrate on the following:

- Use diagrams to illustrate your points and tables or figures to summarise data.
- Comment on interesting features of your plots (frequency and amplitude of peaks, units of vertical axis, unexpected features in the data, etc.).
- Make sure you discuss the major features of the measured data (the main peaks, comparison between methods, validity of system-coupling theory).
- There is no need to regurgitate chunks of Part I material. Refer to such material in passing while making particular observations on measured data.

The report should be submitted online using the 3C6 Moodle page as a PDF file, within the usual time allowed for lab hand-ins. You should then attend the next available feedback session for discussion — please allow at least 24 hours for report marking between hand-in and attending a feedback session. Feedback sessions last for 30 minutes - the feedback dates and locations are on Moodle. Attendance at the feedback session is very strongly advised — but if you can't make the designated session and there is a later one available, you can attend that instead. If you intend to submit an FTR on this experiment, you are advised to do the experiment early enough in the term that you can attend a feedback session well before the FTR hand-in deadline.

5. Write-up for Full Technical Report (10 additional hours)

Guidance on the preparation of Full Technical Reports is provided both in Appendix I of the General Instructions document and in the CUED booklet A guide to report writing, with which you were issued in the first year. The experimental plots from your Laboratory Report should be included. The written material from your Laboratory Report will be superseded by this fuller account, perhaps corrected in the light of information from the feedback session. Remember that this report will be assessed both on technical content and on quality of presentation. It should be written as a technical report using a full sentences and paragraphs (not just bullet point lists).

The following additional questions should be discussed in your Full Technical Report:

1. Does the form of the transfer functions you have measured agree with what you expect based on the lecture notes for the module?
2. What governs the shape of the force pulse from the hammer? How does this then determine the bandwidth of the frequency spectrum of the force? *Hint: look in the Information Data Book.* Why does the hammer have a rubber tip?
3. How well do the measured and 'predicted' admittances of the coupled cantilevers agree? Are the predicted frequencies the same? Are there other discrepancies? How do these discrepancies arise? How could the measurement procedure be improved to reduce discrepancies?

4. What are the main advantages and drawbacks of the three approaches to forcing (sinusoidal, random and impulsive)? For each of the three, suggest a type of application for which it might be the best. Think about size, power, method of attachment, test speed, frequency range, signal-to-noise ratio .... Do not fall into the trap of thinking that the 'best' test method is the one which has an input force 'most similar' to the type of forcing in the real application — remember that provided linear theory is applicable, any type of input force should theoretically give the same transfer function.
5. What do your measurements tell you about the damping of the cantilever system? *Hint: refer to your Mechanics Data Book.* Why might you expect more damping in the coupled system?

The report should be submitted online using the 3C6 Moodle page as a PDF file.